

remains the world's most popular web server software till date.

Attempts at renaming the commercially unattractive 'free software' to something that would emphasise the commercial benefits of sharing the source code with the public while not scaring profit motives away culminated in the coining of the term "open source". This caused a small ideological split in the open source community as some (such as Stallman) felt the new name undermined the philosophical and ethical aspects of free software.

Microsoft's policy of bundling Internet Explorer with Windows

is deemed to be what brought about the demise of the web browser that once dominated the market, a practice for which Microsoft was penalised in court for 'monopolistic practices'.

With increased awareness among the software industry and users about the benefits of open source, the open source movement continued to grow. Entire companies such as Red Hat Inc. developed open source software, generating income through consultancy and solutions services.

Other notable developments in the history of open source include the development of the X Window System, KDE and



Netscape was the first to open up in the browser scene



OpenOffice.org is fast emerging as an attractive open source alternative to Microsoft Office.

DID YOU KNOW?

The birth of modern open source as we know it was in 1998, when Netscape Communications Corporation decided to release the source code of its then popular Netscape Navigator programme (this code is now found in Mozilla Firefox, among others) to the public as free software. This act prompted the free software community to rethink its philosophy to try and make free software attractive to commercial software firms.